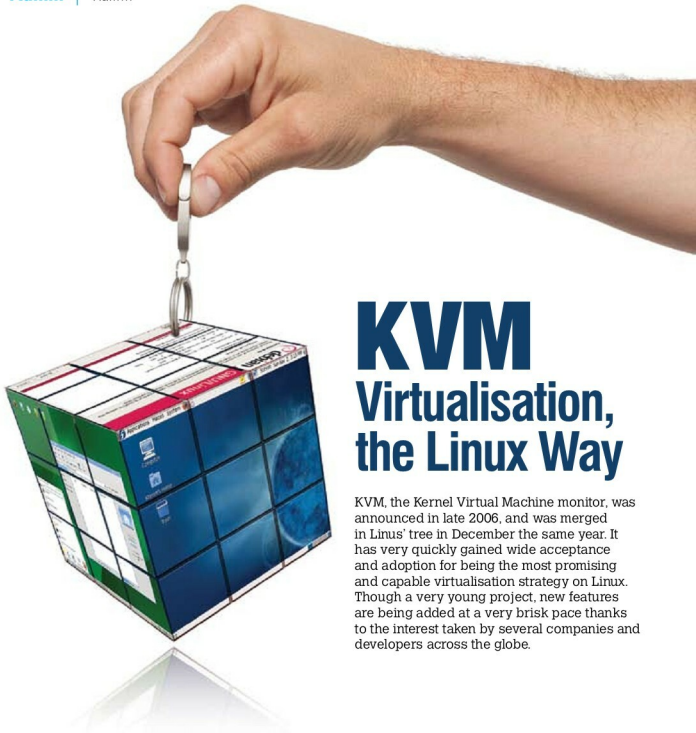




KVM

Virtualisation, the Linux Way

KVM, the Kernel Virtual Machine monitor, was announced in late 2006, and was merged in Linus' tree in December the same year. It has very quickly gained wide acceptance and adoption for being the most promising and capable virtualisation strategy on Linux. Though a very young project, new features are being added at a very brisk pace thanks to the interest taken by several companies and developers across the globe.

*B*efore we look at KVM, let's go over what virtualisation is, in the context of the technologies available and then move on to what makes KVM different and how easy it is to use.

'Virtualisation' means the simulation of a computer system, in software. The virtualisation software creates an

environment for a 'guest', which is a complete OS, to execute within this created world. This means that the view that should get exported to the guest should be of a complete computer system, with the processor, system peripherals, devices, buses, memory and so on. The virtualisation software can be strict about what view to export to the guest -- for